

Math 403 Midterm #2, Spring 2025

Instructor: Ezra Miller

[1pt] Solutions by: Thomas Kidane

I verify that I have consulted no electronic or human sources except those allowed and that I have in all other ways complied with Duke's code of academic honesty.

[1pt] Signature : I agree

Due Date: 11:59pm Thursday 17 April 2025

What you've written generally indicates nuanced comprehension of what was being asked. Your explanations, when they are correct—which is most of the time—are logical and readable. Work on precision, especially details of mathematical definitions, since it might save you from errors.

81/100

PROBLEMS

1. Fix an $n \times n$ complex matrix A . Among all of the eigenvalues of A , let λ be one of maximal absolute value. If σ is the largest singular value of A , show that $|\lambda| \leq \sigma$.

Solution

It is enough to look at points on the unit circle/sphere/hyper-sphere, since all other vectors are just linear scalings of these vectors. Take the Schmidt decomposition of A .

$$Ax = \sum_{k=1}^n \sigma_k(x, v_k) w_k$$

Where n is the number of singular values (for the sake of simplicity I also consider singular values that are 0), the v 's and w 's orthogonal. If we show that the norm of Ax for any unit vector x is bounded by σ_{max} , then any vector in any eigenspace is bounded by σ and therefore λ is also bounded by σ_{max} .

Take any x in the unit sphere, then it can be decomposed into v 's, because the v 's are an orthonormal basis.

$$\begin{aligned} x &= \alpha_1 v_1 + \cdots + \alpha_n v_n \\ |x|^2 &= 1 = \alpha_1^2 |v_1|^2 + \cdots + \alpha_n^2 |v_n|^2 \\ 1 &= \alpha_1^2 + \cdots + \alpha_n^2 \end{aligned}$$

There are no mixed terms since the v 's are orthogonal.

There's a lot of text before the final two sentences. Only the sentence "If we show..." is needed. The rest should be deleted.

$$|A(\alpha_1 v_1 + \cdots + \alpha_n v_n)|^2 = |\alpha_1 w_1 \sigma_{\max} + \cdots + \alpha_n \alpha_n \sigma_n|$$

$$\alpha_1^2 \sigma_{\max} + \cdots + \alpha_n^2 \sigma_n \leq \sigma_{\max}$$

There are no mixed terms since the w 's are orthogonal. Since the magnitude of the unit vectors are bounded by the maximum singular value, assume some λ is the max eigenvalue. Then take the unit vector, we know that this is bounded by $\sigma_{\max}$ after applying A to it, therefore $\lambda \leq \sigma_{\max}$.

2. Fix $A \in \mathbb{C}^{n \times n}$ and $\varepsilon > 0$. Prove that there is a consistent matrix norm $\|\cdot\|$ such 9/14 that $\rho(A) \leq \|A\| \leq \rho(A) + \varepsilon$. Conclude that the spectral radius of A satisfies $\rho(A) = \inf_{\|\cdot\|} \|A\|$, where the infimum is taken over all consistent matrix norms $\|\cdot\|$.

Solution

Lemma 1: The infinity norm is a consistent norm. Refer to Matrix Perturbation theory, chapter 2.

Lemma 2: $v_T(X) := v(TXT^{-1})$ is consistent norm if v is a consistent norm and T is invertible.

Pf: We want $v_T(AB) \leq v_T(A)v_T(B)$, but if we plug in our definition, we

$$v(TABT^{-1}) \leq v(TAT^{-1})v(TBT^{-1})$$

But this is true since v is consistent (Take the matrix being applied to as $A = TAT^{-1}$ and $B = TBT^{-1}$).

Now we can take the jordan normal form of A , then scale the basis so that the elements on the super diagonal are less than ϵ . Then we can make a consistent norm that applies the infinity norm on this (We can use lemma 2 to get rid of the unitary matrices in the jordan normal form decomposition). And we are done, since the maximum sum of the absolute values of the elements in the rows are less than $\rho(A) + \epsilon$. We can make a sequence of decreasing norms, but the lower bound is $\rho(A)$ since for any consistent norm $\rho(A) \leq v(A)$, and we can make a norm such that $v(A) < \rho(A) + \epsilon$ for any $\epsilon > 0$.

3. Show that equality in Elsner's theorem happens if and only if $A = \omega \|A\| I$ for some 14/14 complex number ω with $|\omega| = 1$ and $\tilde{A}$ has $-\omega \|\tilde{A}\|$ as an eigenvalue, where $\|A\|$ is the operator norm of A .

Solution

For the take of simplicity I have listed the original proof for Elsner's theorem below so that refer to it line by line, credit to G.W. Stewart and Ji-guang Sun for their book.

This solution is more or less correct in its broad strokes but is missing details, contains deductive errors, and has deficient citations.

Be more precise in your citation. I need to know precisely what result you're citing to evaluate whether it says what you think it says or need it to say.

Details required.

The Jordan form theorem does not claim that the change-of-basis matrix can be chosen unitary.

good, logical, readable

Theorem 1 (1.3 (Elsner)). *For any A and $\tilde{A}$,*

$$hd(A, \tilde{A}) \leq (\|A\|_2 + \|\tilde{A}\|_2)^{1-\frac{1}{n}} \|E\|_2^{\frac{1}{n}}.$$

Proof. Since the right-hand side of (1.4) is symmetric in A and $\tilde{A}$, it is sufficient to prove that it bounds $sv_A(\tilde{A})$. Assume the maximum in (1.1) is attained for the eigenvalue λ of $\tilde{A}$, and let $x_1, \dots, x_n$ be orthonormal vectors with $\tilde{A}x_1 = \lambda x_1$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} sv_A(\tilde{A})^n &\leq \prod_i |\lambda_i - \tilde{\lambda}| \\ &= \det(A - \tilde{\lambda}I) \\ &\leq \prod_i \|(A - \tilde{\lambda}I)x_i\|_2 \quad [\text{Hadamard inequality (1.2.2)}] \\ &= \|(A - \tilde{A})x_1\|_2 \prod_{i>1} \|(A - \tilde{\lambda}I)x_i\|_2 \\ &\leq \|E\|_2 (\|A\|_2 + \|\tilde{A}\|_2)^{n-1}. \end{aligned}$$

□

Sufficiency($\rightarrow$):

Since the eigenvalues of A are the same we all only need to focus on the eigenvalues of $\tilde{A}$, and since it has the eigenvalue, $-\omega\tilde{A}$ which is in the opposite direction of ω the biggest difference is between this two eigenvalues, because any other eigenvalue can only be closer and not farther since this eigenvalue is in the opposite direction and has the largest magnitude possible. ✓

Therefore $sv_A^n = (\|\omega A\| + \|\omega\tilde{A}\|)^n = (\|A\| + \|\tilde{A}\|)^n$ (you can just add the magnitudes to get the difference), we also know that $\|E\|$ is $(\|A\| + \|\tilde{A}\|)$ from the last line in the proof of Elsner's Theorem. We also know that $\|(A - \tilde{\lambda}I)x_i\| = \|\omega A\| + \|\omega\tilde{A}\| = (\|A\| + \|\tilde{A}\|)$. So we have equality.

Necessity($\leftarrow$):

For the first line to become equality we need that all the eigenvalues of A have to be the same, let this value be $\omega\|A\|$ (The eigenvalue's magnitude will be the operator norm if all the eigenvalues are the same). For the Hadamard inequality to become equality on the third line we need that $\|(A - \tilde{\lambda}I)x_i\|_2$ are an orthogonal set (That is when the Hadamard inequality becomes equality). Continuing on the transition from the 4th to last line we need to have that, $\|(A - \tilde{\lambda}I)x_i\|_2 = (\|A\|_2 + \|\tilde{A}\|_2)$, but for the triangle inequality to become equality, we need that the vectors be parallel. So the x_i 's are an eigenvector of A . I couldn't prove that A is diagonal (it would be diagonal if all vectors were in its eigenspace but I can't guarantee such a strong condition, since it depends $\tilde{A}$), but I can still say that $\tilde{\lambda}$ would have to be $-\omega\|\tilde{A}\|$, since it has to be in

the opposite direction of $\omega||A||$. Ofcourse $|\omega|$ has to be 1, since the eigenvalues of $|A|$ are all the same. And from this we also know that $||E|| = ||A|| + ||\tilde{A}||$. Completing the proof. On a sidenote, A would have to be diagonal, if it was written the basis of the eigenvectors of $\tilde{A}$, then it would satisfy the property, but I can't guarantee that either.

4. Prove that the coefficients of the characteristic polynomial p_φ of a linear transformation $\varphi : V \rightarrow V$ of a vector space V of dimension n all have (basis-free!) interpretations in terms of determinants and traces by showing that $p_\varphi(t) = \sum_j (-1)^j \text{tr}(\bigwedge^j \varphi) t^{n-j}$.

Solution

Assume we are working in basis of eigenvectors.

It's okay to treat the diagonalizable case first, I suppose, as long as you get to the arbitrary case later. Alas, I don't see that you did that.

$$\varphi(v_i) = \lambda_i v_i$$

(1)

$$\text{tr} \left(\bigwedge^r \varphi \right) = \sum_{\sigma \in \binom{[dim V]}{r}} \bigwedge_{i=1}^r \varphi(v_{\sigma_i})$$

(2)

$$\text{tr} \left(\bigwedge^r \varphi \right) = \sum_{\sigma \in \binom{[dim V]}{r}} \prod_{i=1}^r \lambda_{\sigma_i}$$

(3)

$$p_\varphi(t) = (t - \lambda_1) * \dots * (t - \lambda_n)$$

(4)

$$p_\varphi(t) = \sum_{i=0}^{dim V} (-1)^{dim V - i} t^i \sum_{\sigma \in \binom{[dim V]}{r}} \prod_{i=1}^r \lambda_{\sigma_i}$$

(5)

$$p_\varphi(t) = \sum_{i=0}^{dim V} (-1)^{dim V - i} t^i \sum_{\sigma \in \binom{[dim V]}{r}} \bigwedge_{i=1}^r \varphi(v_{\sigma_i})$$

(6)

$$p_\varphi(t) = \sum_{i=0}^{dim V} (-1)^{dim V - i} t^i \text{tr} \left(\bigwedge^r \varphi \right)$$

(7)

(8)

We extend the proof to any basis(basis-free) by noting that $\bigwedge \varphi$ is a linear function, therefore the trace doesn't change since it is a property of the linear transformation, not its representation. So the trace is the same in any basis, therefore this fact works independent of the basis you working in.

To Extend it to the case of any basis, take the generalized eigenvectors.

$$\varphi(v_1) = \lambda_1 v_1$$

$$\varphi(v_2) = \lambda_1 v_2 + v_1$$

If v_2 is a generalized eigenvector eigenvalue λ_1 . I think the result is the same in the case of the $j = 1$, and I want to extend this to all values.

$$\begin{aligned}\wedge^2 \varphi(v_2 \wedge v_1) &= (\lambda_1 v_2 + v_1) \wedge (\lambda_1 v_1) \\ &= (\lambda_1^2 v_1) \wedge (v_2) + (\lambda_1 v_1) \wedge (v_2)\end{aligned}$$

Ok now I know it works, I just need to generalize this. Let there be an arbitrary sequence of basis vectors and I take the wedge product I want to prove that the entries on diagonal corresponding to to this sequence after applying the functor is no different than if I had just multiplied the corresponding eigenvalues.

$$\wedge^l \varphi(v_1 \wedge v_2 \wedge \cdots \wedge v_l) = \varphi(v_1) \wedge \cdots \wedge \varphi(v_l)$$

Assume without loss of generality that they are arranged in such a way that for basis vectors with the same eigenvalue the generalized eigenvectors come first (What happens when the signs change? We will see that it is irrelevant).

When we apply φ to a generalized eigenvector we get the generalized eigenvector and the next lower vector in the generalized eigenvector cycle or the eigenvector (That one that actually spans) itself. We can decompose the result by using the properties of the wedge such that we have two terms: one has the generalized eigenvector and the other doesn't. Through this process we eventually decompose the result into the sum of the basis in the wedge space, and since the only one that matches our basis from when we started is the one such that we take the generalized eigenvector, and therefore its coefficient is the product of the eigenvalues of the basis vectors in the wedge product.

Since we only care about the trace, this is not different than if there were no super diagonal elements in the Jordan normal form, so we can use the above result to get the same result and generalize this result to the max!

5. Let $A \in \mathbb{R}^{2 \times 2}$ be a diagonal matrix. What conditions on A guarantee that the exponential map $\exp_{iA} : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow GL_2(\mathbb{C})$ sending $t \mapsto e^{itA}$ is injective? Set $G = \exp_{iA}(\mathbb{R})$, the image of $\exp_{iA}$. When $\exp_{iA}$ is injective, can it be that for every open interval $I \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ there is an open subset $U \subseteq GL_2(\mathbb{C})$ such that $\exp_{iA}(I) = U \cap G$?

Solution

Since A is diagonal that means

The reason you scored so high is that you exhibited complete understanding of what was being asked—this is already a big step, for the second half—and furthermore explained accurately how the proof should go. It wouldn't take so much to make your reasoning completely precise.

✓

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} a & 0 \\ 0 & b \end{bmatrix}$$

$$e^{itA} = \begin{bmatrix} e^{ita} & 0 \\ 0 & e^{itb} \end{bmatrix}$$

For the function to be injective it needs to be the case, $\exp_{iA}(t_1) \neq \exp_{iA}(t_2) \iff t_1 \neq t_2$.

e^{ita} goes in a cycle of period $\frac{2\pi}{a}$, same thing for e^{itb} , with period $\frac{2\pi}{b}$.

If $\exists t_1$ and t_2 s.t $t_1 \neq t_2$ and $\exp_{iA}(t_1) = \exp_{iA}(t_2)$, then that means the two values must have cycled, which means that you can find $x, y \in \mathbb{Z}$ s.t $\frac{2x\pi}{a} = \frac{2y\pi}{b} \rightarrow xb = ay \rightarrow a/b \in \mathbb{Q}$. So a/b must be irrational for the map to be injective, this condition is also sufficient, since for the two values to repeat, it must be that case that the ratio of their periods rational otherwise you couldn't find a period in which both the values would repeat.

The arrow for "implies" is " $\Rightarrow$ ", not " $\rightarrow$ ". It has become distracting enough for me to write this comment.

Again, good logical readable explanation.

I think the second value is false. Imagine $\mathbb{R}^8$ (very hard I know), this space is close enough (there are some matrices that aren't complex linear but this proof lost its rigour already) to the space of invertible complex matrices. The question is equivalent to asking if I can make an open subset in this subspace, s.t its intersection with the image of the function is some range. Assume there is some open set you can make such that this is true. I argue, that there is a point in that subspace that is not in your range, my justification is that I can make an arbitrarily close approximation of any value in your range, but its inverse will be arbitrarily far.

(meh—you get used to it) (not yet...)

Let's take a concrete example, say $a = 1$ and $b = \sqrt{2}$. Assume you made some open subset in $GL_2(\mathbb{C})$, such the intersection of this subspace with the image corresponded to the interval $(-1, 1)$. Obviously, $GL_2(\mathbb{C})$ has a norm, you can view it as a space that is isomorphic to $\mathbb{R}^8$ and do the normal euclidean norm. I argue I can find a matrix in the image, that is arbitrarily close to I in euclidean distance terms, but not in the interval because I can find some arbitrarily large value of x such that $|I - \exp_{iA}(x)| < \epsilon$, for any $\epsilon > 0$. Why? assume I fix ϵ , then I keep increasing x , the values of e^{ita} and e^{itb} keep looping, but they are never in sync, everytime there is some gap between their positions, this gap never goes to zero, but it doesn't diverge either, it keeps oscillating, and at some point with probability 1*, it gets close enough to 0, arbitrarily closely (therefore arbitrarily close to I).

So far, so good: this is absolutely what happens.

: gap

The basic idea of my proof is that, the image is too dense, any level of precision is insufficient since there are infinitely many ranges in a nonzero amount of volume (you have fit the whole number line in the small hypercube).

6. Fix $A \geq 0$ in $\mathbb{R}^{n \times n}$. Let $a_{ij}^{(k)}$ be the ij entry of A^k . Assume for each i and j that $a_{ij}^{(k)} \neq 0$ 10/14

for some $k \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$ that may depend on i and j . Prove that $(I_n + A)^{n-1} > 0$.

Solution

The exact magnitudes of the entries in the A don't matter, replace all positive entries with 1 from now on. Imagine n cities, let there be a one directional road from city i to city j , if $a_{ij} = 1$ (We replaced the positive entries of A with 1, so this is equivalent to saying that the original entry had a positive value).

Taking the powers of A is equivalent to taking walks along this city (graph), more specifically $a_{ij}^{(k)} > 0$ tells you whether there is a path that consists of k roads from city i to city j . Therefore, saying that $a_{ij}^{(k)} > 0$ for some k is equivalent to saying that a path exists from city i to city j which consists of k roads for some k .

While this is true, you can't just say so at the start. It needs to be justified, and by the time you've said enough to justify it, there's little benefit to the assumption. Even as things stand, you've had to include extra sentences related to the assumption. Just think of the positive entries as distances; no need to comment further.

Justify use of binomial theorem.

$$\begin{aligned}(I + A)^{n-1} &= \sum_{i=0}^{n-1} \binom{n-1}{i} I^i A^{n-1-i} \\ &= I + (n-1)A + \cdots + A^{n-1}\end{aligned}$$

For an entry in $(I + A)^{n-1}$ to be zero it must mean that there is no path between some two cities that contains any number of roads between 0 to $n-1$ roads, but that is just nonsense because we know that there is a path between any two cities and no path between any two cities need not be longer than $n-1$ (if you start at one city and can get to another city, then the shortest path between the city you are in and the other city, can't be longer than $n-1$, otherwise you had to revisit one city). $(I + A)^{n-1}$ effectively takes a snapshot of all paths between any two cities, and since we said that you can get from one city to any other city after some number of walks, all the entries in $(I + A)^{n-1}$ must be strictly positive.

OK, now we've become too informal.

Instead of talking about snapshots, talk about summing nonnegative numbers and getting 0 if and only if all are 0—or something like that. In summary, be precise.

7. Suppose that U is a normal operator whose eigenvalues all lie on the unit circle in $\mathbb{C}$. Must U be unitary? Give a proof or counterexample. 14/14

Solution

From Theorem 2.4 in Chapter 6 Lax, we know that any normal operator U in a complex vector space has an orthonormal basis of eigenvectors. Take the decomposition of U to be PDP^* , where P is unitary and D diagonal. If we multiply this by its conjugate transpose. $PDP^*PD^*P^* = PD^*DP^* = PDD^*P^* \rightarrow DD^* = D^*D \rightarrow I$, since the values on the diagonal have absolute value 1, and multiplying a complex number by its conjugate gets you its magnitude. Therefore N^* is the inverse of N , since $PIP^* = I$, since P is unitary, which means N is unitary.